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THE CLUES BEFORE THE KING

A Fun Adventure Through Old Testament Prophecies

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A Note for Parents

Have you ever played a game of hide and seek? Someone hides. Someone seeks. The seeker looks everywhere. They look under the bed. They look in the closet. They look behind the door. They are looking for clues. They are looking for the hidden one. The Old Testament is like a game of hide and seek. God hid clues. He hid them in stories. He hid them in prophecies. He hid them in symbols. And the clues all point to one person. They all point to the King. They all point to Jesus.

This book is a 30 day adventure for you and your kids. We are going to search for the clues. We are going to find the hidden King. You do not need to be a Bible expert to lead this. You just need to be willing to explore with your kids. Get ready to put on your detective hats. Get ready to follow the clues. Get ready to find the King.

How to Use This Book

This is a 30 day journey. Each day takes about 5 to 10 minutes. Read the secret clue. Read the big reveal. Do the family activity together. Say the prayer out loud. Let your child color the picture. The goal is not perfection. The goal is connection. Have fun with it. Get messy. Ask questions. Laugh together. This is an adventure. Let us begin.

Day 01: The Clue of the Hero

The Secret Clue (OT)

"He will crush your head, and you will strike his heel." - Genesis 3:15

A long, long time ago, at the very beginning of the world, a sneaky snake tricked Adam and Eve. But God was not surprised. God told the snake something very important. He said, "One day, a special Hero is going to come and crush your head. You might hurt His heel. But He is going to win forever." This was the very first secret clue about the King.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"God sent his Son, born of a woman..." - Galatians 4:4

Guess what? That Hero is Jesus. He came to earth to fight the bad guy. The bad guy is sin. The bad guy is death. Jesus might have been hurt on the cross. It looked like the snake won. But Jesus rose from the dead. He crushed the snake's head. He won forever.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a sneaky snake on a piece of paper. Talk about how Jesus is stronger than the snake. Then crumple up the paper and throw it in the trash can together. Say it out loud together: "Jesus wins!"

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my hero. Thank you for winning the big battle against sin. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A shoe stepping on a snake with a big glowing smile.

Day 02: The Clue of the Blessing

The Secret Clue (OT)
"All peoples on earth will be blessed through you." - Genesis 12:3

God talked to a man named Abraham. Abraham was very old. He did not have any children. He traveled from place to place with his animals. But God made a big promise. God said, "Through your family, I am going to bless the whole world." That is a huge promise. It meant that one day, someone from Abraham's family would change everything. That someone is Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"This is the genealogy of Jesus the Messiah the son of David, the son of Abraham..." - Matthew 1:1

Jesus is part of Abraham's family. He is the one who blesses the whole world. Through Jesus, people from every country and every language can be forgiven. The promise to Abraham came true in Jesus.

Family Activity
Draw a big family tree on a piece of paper. Put a star at the top. Write the name Jesus next to the star. Talk about how Jesus is part of a big family, and now you are part of His family too.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for keeping your promises. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you for making me part of your family. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big family tree with a shining star at the top.

Day 03: The Clue of the King

The Secret Clue (OT)
"The scepter will not depart from Judah..." - Genesis 49:10

Jacob was very old. He was dying. He called his twelve sons to his bed. He gave each son a special blessing. When he got to his son Judah, he said something strange. He said, "The scepter will not depart from Judah." A scepter is a stick a king holds. It is a sign of power. Jacob was saying that kings would come from Judah. He was also saying that one day, the ultimate King would come. That King is Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For it is clear that our Lord descended from Judah..." - Hebrews 7:14

Jesus came from the tribe of Judah. He is the King of Kings. Jacob's words were not just a family blessing. They were a secret clue about Jesus.

Family Activity
Make a paper crown. Decorate it with stickers or crayons. Put it on your child's head and say, "You are a child of the King."

Kid's Prayer
"Jesus, you are my King. Thank you for being a good king. Help me to follow you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A shiny golden crown with jewels.

Day 04: The Clue of the Star

The Secret Clue (OT)
"A star will come out of Jacob..." - Numbers 24:17

A man named Balaam was not an Israelite. He was not a follower of God. But God used him to speak a secret clue. Balaam looked at the people of Israel. He said, "I see him, but not now. A star will come out of Jacob." He was talking about a future King. He was talking about the Messiah. He said a star would signal His birth.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"We saw his star when it rose and have come to worship him." - Matthew 2:2

When Jesus was born, wise men came from the east. They were star gazers. They saw a special star in the sky. They knew the ancient clue. They followed the star. It led them to Jesus. They bowed down and worshiped Him.

Family Activity
Turn off the lights. Use a flashlight to make a star on the ceiling. Talk about how the star led the wise men to Jesus.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for the star that pointed to Jesus. Help me to follow the clues that lead to you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A bright star shining in the night sky over a little house.

Day 05: The Clue of the Prophet

The Secret Clue (OT)
"I will raise up for them a prophet like you..." - Deuteronomy 18:18

Moses was the greatest leader of Israel. He parted the Red Sea. He received the Ten Commandments. He talked to God face to face. But Moses said something surprising. He said, "God will raise up a prophet like me." He said someone else was coming. Someone even greater. This new prophet would speak God's words. That prophet is Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"For Moses said, 'The Lord your God will raise up for you a prophet like me...'" - Acts 3:22

Jesus is the new Moses. Moses led people out of slavery in Egypt. Jesus leads people out of slavery to sin. Moses gave the law. Jesus gives grace. Jesus is the greater prophet.

Family Activity
Play a game of "Follow the Leader." Let your child be the leader. Talk about how we follow Jesus because He is the best leader.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my leader. Help me to follow you every day. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A man holding a wooden staff with a big smile.

Day 06: The Clue of the Branch

The Secret Clue (OT)

"A shoot will come up from the stump of Jesse..." - Isaiah 11:1

Jesse was the father of King David. David was a great king. But his family line looked like a dead stump. It looked finished. It looked like nothing would ever grow there again. But Isaiah said, "A shoot will come up from the stump of Jesse." He said a little Branch would grow. This was a promise that the royal line would not die. A new King was coming. That King is Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"The Root of Jesse will spring up..." - Romans 15:12

Jesus is that Branch. He came from the line of David. He is the King who rose from a dead family line. He brings new life.

Family Activity
Take a small plant or a stick. Talk about how God makes things grow. Plant a seed in a cup and watch it grow over the next few weeks.

Kid's Prayer
"God, you bring life to dead things. Thank you for the little Branch. Thank you for Jesus. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A small green leaf growing from an old brown stump.

Day 07: The Clue of the Miracle Baby

The Secret Clue (OT)
"The virgin will conceive and give birth to a son..." - Isaiah 7:14

Isaiah was a prophet. He spoke to a king named Ahaz. Ahaz was worried about his enemies. God said, "Ask me for a sign." Ahaz said no. So God gave a sign anyway. God said, "A virgin will have a baby. The baby will be called Immanuel." Immanuel means "God with us." This was a miracle. This was a secret clue about Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"The virgin will conceive and give birth to a son, and they will call him Immanuel." - Matthew 1:23

Mary was a virgin. She became pregnant by the power of the Holy Spirit. She gave birth to Jesus. He is God with us. He is the miracle baby.

Family Activity
Look at baby pictures together. Talk about how Jesus was a baby too. He was a miracle baby.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for sending baby Jesus. Thank you for being with us. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A baby in a manger with a bright light shining around him.

Day 08: The Clue of the Tiny Town

The Secret Clue (OT)
"But you, Bethlehem... out of you will come for me one who will be ruler over Israel..." - Micah 5:2

Micah was a prophet. He looked at the towns of Judah. He said, "Bethlehem, you are small." Bethlehem was a tiny town. It was not a big city. But Micah said the ruler of Israel would come from Bethlehem. This was a specific address. This was a secret clue. It had a zip code.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"So Joseph also went up from the town of Nazareth... to Bethlehem..." - Luke 2:4

Joseph and Mary lived in Nazareth. But the Roman emperor ordered a census. Everyone had to go to their ancestral town. Joseph was from the line of David. David was from Bethlehem. So Joseph and Mary traveled to Bethlehem. Jesus was born there. The tiny town. The specific address.

Family Activity
Draw a map from your house to Bethlehem. Talk about the long journey Mary and Joseph took.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for planning every detail. Thank you for caring about small towns and small people. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A tiny town with a big star shining over it.

Day 09: The Clue of the Mighty God

The Secret Clue (OT)
"And he will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace." - Isaiah 9:6

These are big titles. Wonderful Counselor. Mighty God. Everlasting Father. Prince of Peace. These are not titles for a normal child. These are titles for God. Isaiah said the coming child would be God. This was a huge secret clue.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"I and the Father are one." - John 10:30

Jesus said something shocking. He said, "I and the Father are one." He was saying He is God. He is the Mighty God. He is the Prince of Peace. He is the baby who is also God.

Family Activity
Practice saying the names of Jesus together. Wonderful Counselor. Mighty God. Everlasting Father. Prince of Peace. Ask your child which name they like best.

Kid's Prayer
"Jesus, you are Mighty God. Thank you for coming to earth. Thank you for being my Prince of Peace. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A baby with a glowing crown and a peaceful smile.

Day 10: The Clue of the Journey

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Out of Egypt I called my son." - Hosea 11:1

Hosea was a prophet. He wrote about the nation of Israel. God called Israel out of Egypt a long time ago. But Matthew saw a deeper meaning. He saw that this verse was also a secret clue about Jesus. Jesus is the true Son of God. He also came out of Egypt.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"So he got up, took the child and his mother during the night and left for Egypt..." - Matthew 2:14-15

King Herod wanted to kill baby Jesus. An angel appeared to Joseph in a dream. The angel said, "Get up. Take the child and his mother and escape to Egypt." Joseph obeyed. He took Mary and Jesus to Egypt. They stayed there until Herod died. Then they came back. The secret clue came true.

Family Activity
Pack a small bag with a toy and a snack. Pretend you are on a journey like Mary and Joseph. Talk about how God protected baby Jesus.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for protecting Jesus. Thank you for protecting me too. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A family walking with a donkey under a big moon.

Day 11: The Clue of the Sad Day

The Secret Clue (OT)
"A voice is heard in Ramah, mourning and great weeping..." - Jeremiah 31:15

Jeremiah was a prophet. He wrote about a sad time. He said there would be crying in a town called Ramah. Rachel would weep for her children. Rachel was a mother in the Bible. This was a sad secret clue. It pointed to a sad day that was coming.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"When Herod realized that he had been outwitted by the Magi, he was furious..." - Matthew 2:16

King Herod was jealous of Jesus. He wanted to kill Him. He ordered his soldiers to kill all the baby boys in Bethlehem. The mothers cried. They wept for their children. The secret clue came true. It was a very sad day.

Family Activity
Talk about a time you were sad. Give each other a big hug. Talk about how God is with us when we are sad.

Kid's Prayer
"God, you see my tears. You know when I am sad. Thank you for being with me. Comfort me today. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A heart with a tear and a bandage on it.

Day 12: The Clue of the Voice

The Secret Clue (OT)
"A voice of one calling: 'In the wilderness prepare the way for the LORD...'" - Isaiah 40:3

Isaiah wrote about a voice in the wilderness. This voice would cry out. It would tell people to get ready. It would say, "The Lord is coming!" This was a secret clue. It meant someone was coming to prepare the way for Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"In those days John the Baptist came, preaching in the wilderness..." - Matthew 3:1-3

John the Baptist was that voice. He lived in the wilderness. He wore camel hair clothes. He ate locusts and honey. He told people to get ready. He told them Jesus was coming. He was the warm up act for Jesus.

Family Activity
Go outside. Cup your hands around your mouth. Shout, "Get ready for Jesus!" Talk about how John the Baptist was a voice in the wild.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, God, for the voices that point to Jesus. Help me to get ready for you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A man shouting in the desert with his hands around his mouth.

Day 13: The Clue of the Healer

The Secret Clue (OT)
"He has sent me to bind up the brokenhearted..." - Isaiah 61:1

Isaiah said the Messiah would be a healer. He would heal the brokenhearted. He would set the captives free. He would give good news to the poor. This was a secret clue. It meant the Messiah would care about people who were hurting.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Today this scripture is fulfilled in your hearing." - Luke 4:21

Jesus went to His hometown. He went to the synagogue. He read this exact passage from Isaiah. Then He sat down. He said, "Today this scripture is fulfilled." He was saying, "I am the healer. I am the one Isaiah talked about."

Family Activity
Take a broken crayon. Tape it back together. Talk about how Jesus heals broken things. He heals broken hearts.

Kid's Prayer
"Jesus, you are the healer. Please heal my heart. Heal the parts of me that hurt. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A heart with a bandage and a big smile.

Day 14: The Clue of the Light

The Secret Clue (OT)
"The people walking in darkness have seen a great light..." - Isaiah 9:1-2

Isaiah talked about a place called Galilee. It was a dark place. It had been invaded. It had been humbled. But Isaiah said the people walking in darkness would see a great light. This was a secret clue. It meant the Messiah would bring light to Galilee.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Leaving Nazareth, he went and lived in Capernaum, which was by the lake in the area of Zebulun and Naphtali..." - Matthew 4:13-16

Jesus moved to Capernaum. This was in Galilee. He began His ministry there. He preached. He healed. He cast out demons. He was the light in the darkness. The secret clue came true.

Family Activity
Turn off all the lights in the room. Then light one candle. Talk about how one small light can fill a dark room. Jesus is the light.

Kid's Prayer
"Jesus, thank you for being the light. Shine your light into my heart. Shine your light into my home. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A candle shining brightly in a dark room.

Day 15: The Clue of the Stone

The Secret Clue (OT)
"The stone the builders rejected has become the cornerstone..." - Psalm 118:22

The Psalmist wrote about a stone. The builders looked at this stone and said, "No, we do not want that one." They threw it away. But then something happened. That rejected stone became the cornerstone. The cornerstone is the most important stone. It holds the building together. This was a secret clue.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"The stone the builders rejected has become the cornerstone..." - Matthew 21:42

Jesus quoted this Psalm. He applied it to Himself. The religious leaders rejected Him. They did not want Him. They killed Him. But God raised Him from the dead. He became the cornerstone of the church. He is the most important stone.

Family Activity
Build a small tower with blocks. Take away the bottom block. Watch the tower fall. Talk about how Jesus is the cornerstone. He holds everything together.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, that you see my worth. Thank you that Jesus was rejected so I could be accepted. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A shiny stone placed at the corner of a wall.

Day 16: The Clue of the Hatred

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Those who hate me without reason outnumber the hairs of my head..." - Psalm 69:4

David wrote this Psalm. He had many enemies. They hated him for no reason. They chased him. They wanted to hurt him. This was a secret clue. It pointed to the Messiah. The Messiah would be hated for no reason.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"They hated me without reason." - John 15:25

Jesus quoted this Psalm. He said the world hated Him without a reason. The religious leaders hated Him. The crowds turned on Him. He was hated for no reason. The secret clue came true.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a time someone was mean to you. Then crumple it up. Talk about how Jesus loves us even when others are mean.

Kid's Prayer
"Jesus, thank you for loving me even when others are mean. Help me to love people who are mean to me. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A hand reaching out with a heart in the palm.

Day 17: The Clue of the Traitor Friend

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Even my close friend... has turned against me." - Psalm 41:9

David wrote this Psalm. He had a close friend who betrayed him. This friend shared his bread. This friend was close to him. But he turned against him. This was a secret clue. It pointed to Judas.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"He who shared my bread has turned against me." - John 13:18

Jesus quoted this Psalm at the Last Supper. He was talking about Judas. Judas was one of His twelve disciples. Judas shared bread with Jesus. Judas was His friend. But Judas betrayed Him. He sold Him for thirty pieces of silver. The secret clue came true.

Family Activity
Play a game of "trust fall." Let your child fall back into your arms. Talk about how Jesus is always trustworthy. He never betrays us.

Kid's Prayer
"Jesus, thank you for being a friend who never betrays. Thank you for always being there for me. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
Two friends holding hands with a big heart between them.

Day 18: The Clue of the Silver Coins

The Secret Clue (OT)
"So they paid me thirty pieces of silver." - Zechariah 11:12

Zechariah was a prophet. He acted out a prophecy. He asked the people for his pay. They paid him thirty pieces of silver. This was a low price. It was the price of a slave. This was a secret clue. It pointed to the betrayal of Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"So they counted out for him thirty pieces of silver." - Matthew 26:15

Judas went to the chief priests. He asked them, "What will you give me if I betray Jesus?" They counted out thirty pieces of silver. This was the exact price. Judas betrayed Jesus for thirty pieces of silver. The secret clue came true.

Family Activity
Count out thirty coins together. Put them in a small bag. Talk about how Jesus was sold for thirty pieces of silver. But He loves us more than any amount of money.

Kid's Prayer
"Jesus, thank you for loving me more than money. Thank you for valuing me. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A small bag with coins spilling out.

Day 19: The Clue of the Silent Lamb

The Secret Clue (OT)
"As a sheep before its shearers is silent, so he did not open his mouth." - Isaiah 53:7

Isaiah said the Messiah would be silent. He would be like a lamb. A lamb is quiet before its shearers. The Messiah would not defend Himself. He would not argue. He would be quiet. This was a secret clue.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"But Jesus made no reply, not even to a single charge..." - Matthew 27:14

Jesus was brought before Pilate. The chief priests accused Him. They lied about Him. Pilate asked, "Don't you hear what they are saying?" Jesus said nothing. He was silent. He was like a lamb. The secret clue came true.

Family Activity
Practice being quiet for thirty seconds. Count to thirty slowly. Talk about how Jesus was quiet and trusted God.

Kid's Prayer
"Jesus, help me to trust you even when I want to argue. Help me to be quiet and trust you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A fluffy white lamb with a gentle smile.

Day 20: The Clue of the Scattered Sheep

The Secret Clue (OT)
"Strike the shepherd, and the sheep will be scattered..." - Zechariah 13:7

Zechariah said the shepherd would be struck. He would be hurt. Then the sheep would run away. The sheep would scatter. This was a secret clue. It pointed to the disciples. They would run away when Jesus was arrested.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"I will strike the shepherd, and the sheep of the flock will be scattered." - Matthew 26:31

Jesus quoted this prophecy. He told His disciples they would all run away. He said the shepherd would be struck. The sheep would scatter. That is exactly what happened. Jesus was arrested. The disciples ran away. The secret clue came true.

Family Activity
Play a game of hide and seek. Let your child hide. Then find them and say, "I always find you!" Talk about how Jesus always finds us, even when we run away.

Kid's Prayer

"Jesus, thank you for always finding me. Thank you for never giving up on me. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A shepherd looking for a lost sheep in the hills.

Day 21: The Clue of the Criminals' Friend

The Secret Clue (OT)
"He was numbered with the transgressors..." - Isaiah 53:12

Isaiah said the Messiah would be numbered with the transgressors. Transgressors are criminals. They are bad guys. The Messiah would be treated like a bad guy. He would be crucified with criminals. This was a secret clue.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Two other men, both criminals, were also led out with him to be executed..." - Luke 23:32-33

Jesus was crucified between two criminals. He was treated like a bad guy. He was numbered with the transgressors. But He prayed for them. He said, "Father, forgive them." The secret clue came true.

Family Activity
Draw two crosses on a piece of paper. Draw a heart between them. Talk about how Jesus was a friend to the criminals. He forgave them.

Kid's Prayer
"Jesus, thank you for forgiving me. Thank you for being my friend. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
Two crosses with a bright heart between them.

Day 22: The Clue of the Pierced Hands

The Secret Clue (OT)
"They pierce my hands and my feet." - Psalm 22:16

David wrote this Psalm. He described a person being attacked. He said, "They pierce my hands and my feet." This was a secret clue. It pointed to the crucifixion. It pointed to Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Unless I see the nail marks in his hands..." - John 20:25

Thomas said he would not believe unless he saw the nail marks. A week later, Jesus appeared to him. Jesus said, "Put your finger here. See my hands." Thomas saw the nail marks. He saw the pierced hands. The secret clue came true.

Family Activity
Put a small star sticker on your child's hand. Tell them it is a reminder of Jesus' love. Every time they see it, they can remember that Jesus loves them.

Kid's Prayer
"Jesus, thank you for the scars you bear for me. Thank you for loving me that much. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A hand with a heart in the palm.

Day 23: The Clue of the Mocking Crowd

The Secret Clue (OT)
"All who see me mock me; they hurl insults, shaking their heads..." - Psalm 22:7-8

David wrote about mockers. They made fun of him. They shook their heads. They said, "He trusts in God. Let God rescue him." This was a secret clue. It pointed to the crucifixion.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Those who passed by hurled insults at him, shaking their heads..." - Matthew 27:39-43

This is exactly what happened at the crucifixion. The people passed by. They insulted Jesus. They shook their heads. They said, "He trusts in God. Let God rescue him." The secret clue came true.

Family Activity
Play a game of "Simon Says." Talk about how Jesus did the right thing even when others were mean to Him.

Kid's Prayer
"Jesus, help me to be brave when people are mean. Help me to do the right thing. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A face with a gentle smile and a crown of thorns.

Day 24: The Clue of the Thirsty Savior

The Secret Clue (OT)
"They put gall in my food and gave me vinegar for my thirst." - Psalm 69:21

David wrote about his suffering. He said they gave him gall and vinegar. Gall is bitter. Vinegar is sour. This was a secret clue. It pointed to the crucifixion.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"There they offered Jesus wine to drink, mixed with gall... Jesus said, 'I am thirsty.'" - Matthew 27:34; John 19:28-29

The soldiers offered Jesus wine mixed with gall. He refused it. Later, He said, "I am thirsty." They gave Him vinegar. The secret clue came true. Even the smallest details came true.

Family Activity
Drink a glass of water together. Say, "Thank you, Jesus, for taking care of me." Talk about how Jesus was thirsty on the cross.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for your love for me. Thank you for taking care of me. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A cup overflowing with cool water.

Day 25: The Clue of the Soldiers' Game

The Secret Clue (OT)
"They divide my clothes among them and cast lots for my garment." - Psalm 22:18

David wrote about soldiers. They divided his clothes. They gambled for his garment. This was a secret clue. It pointed to the crucifixion.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Let's decide by lot who will get it." - John 19:23-24

The soldiers took the clothes of Jesus. They divided them into four shares. The undergarment was seamless. They said, "Let's not tear it. Let's cast lots for it." So they gambled for the garment. The secret clue came true.

Family Activity
Play a matching game with cards or socks. Talk about how the soldiers played a game for Jesus' clothes. But Jesus was playing a bigger game. He was winning the victory over sin.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for being my winner. Thank you for winning the victory. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A folded tunic with a pair of dice next to it.

Day 26: The Clue of the Loud Cry

The Secret Clue (OT)
"My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?" - Psalm 22:1

David wrote this Psalm. He felt alone. He felt abandoned. He cried out to God. This was a secret clue. It pointed to Jesus on the cross.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?" - Matthew 27:46

Jesus quoted this Psalm on the cross. He cried out with a loud voice. He was feeling the weight of the world's sin. He was separated from the Father. The secret clue came true.

Family Activity
Have your child shout "I love you!" across the room. Talk about how Jesus cried out to God. He did it so we would never be alone.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, that I am never alone. Thank you for being with me always. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A child shouting with a big heart and a bright smile.

Day 27: The Clue of the Rich Man's Gift

The Secret Clue (OT)
"He was assigned a grave with the wicked, and with the rich in his death..." - Isaiah 53:9

Isaiah said the Messiah would be buried with the wicked. But he also said he would be with the rich. This was a strange secret clue. How can you be buried with criminals and with a rich man? The answer is in the story of Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"Joseph took the body, wrapped it in a clean linen cloth, and placed it in his own new tomb..." - Matthew 27:57-60

Joseph of Arimathea was a rich man. He was a disciple of Jesus. He asked Pilate for the body of Jesus. He took the body. He wrapped it in clean linen. He placed it in his own new tomb. This was a rich man's tomb. The secret clue came true.

Family Activity
Draw a picture of a beautiful cave tomb with a big round stone in front of it.

Kid's Prayer

"Thank you, God, for being generous to me. Thank you for taking care of every detail. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A cave with a big round stone in front and a garden around it.

Day 28: The Clue of the Empty Tomb

The Secret Clue (OT)
"You will not abandon me to the realm of the dead..." - Psalm 16:10

David wrote this Psalm. He said God would not abandon him to the grave. He said God would not let his body decay. This was a secret clue. It pointed to the resurrection.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"God has raised this Jesus to life, and we are all witnesses of it." - Acts 2:32

Peter preached this on the day of Pentecost. He said David was a prophet. He said David knew the Messiah would rise from the dead. Peter said this was fulfilled in Jesus. God raised Jesus to life. The secret clue came true.

Family Activity
Find a hollow plastic egg. Put a small treat inside. Talk about the empty tomb. The tomb is empty. Jesus is alive.

Kid's Prayer
"Jesus, you are alive! Thank you for rising from the dead. Because you live, I will live forever. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
An empty tomb with a big sunrise behind it.

Day 29: The Clue of the Victory March

The Secret Clue (OT)
"When you ascended on high, you took many captives..." - Psalm 68:18

David wrote about a victorious king. The king goes up high. He takes captives. He receives gifts. This was a secret clue. It pointed to the ascension of Jesus.

The Big Reveal (NT)
"When he ascended on high, he took many captives and gave gifts to his people." - Ephesians 4:8

Paul quoted this Psalm. He applied it to Jesus. Jesus went up to heaven. He took many captives. He gave gifts to His people. The secret clue came true. Jesus won the victory.

Family Activity
Give your child a small gift. A sticker. A piece of candy. Talk about how Jesus gives us gifts. He gives us His love. He gives us His peace.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for the gifts you give me. Thank you for sharing your victory with me. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A man going up into the clouds with his arms raised in victory.

Day 30: The Clue of the Forever King

The Secret Clue (OT)
"His dominion is an everlasting dominion that will not pass away..." - Daniel 7:14

Daniel had a vision. He saw one like a son of man. He came with the clouds. He was given authority. He was given glory. His kingdom would never end

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Day 30: The Clue of the Forever King (Continued)

The Big Reveal (NT)
"The kingdom of the world has become the kingdom of our Lord and of his Messiah, and he will reign for ever and ever." - Revelation 11:15

This is the final fulfillment. The kingdom of the world becomes the kingdom of our Lord. Jesus reigns forever. His kingdom will never end. The secret clue came true.

Family Activity
Have a King's Party. Make crowns. Eat cookies. Play a treasure hunt. Talk about how Jesus is the Forever King. He will reign forever and ever.

Kid's Prayer
"Thank you, Jesus, for making me part of your Forever Kingdom. I love you. Amen."

Coloring Prompt
A big golden throne with a crown on top and a rainbow behind it.

END MATTER

The "Prophecy Detective" Certificate

This certifies that [Child's Name] has completed The Clues Before the King adventure. You followed 30 secret clues and discovered the greatest treasure: Jesus. You are officially a Divine Blueprint Detective.

Date: _____

Signed by (Parent or Teacher): _____

Family Discussion Cards

Card 1: What was the coolest clue you found this week?
Card 2: What is your favorite prophecy from the Old Testament?
Card 3: Why do you think God gave so many clues about Jesus?
Card 4: How does it feel to know Jesus is the greatest treasure?
Card 5: Who is someone you can tell about Jesus?
Card 6: What is your favorite prayer from this book?
Card 7: If you could ask Jesus one question, what would it be?
Card 8: What is one way you can show Jesus' love to someone today?
Card 9: What is your favorite coloring page from this book?
Card 10: What is one thing you want to remember about Jesus forever?

A Note for the Parent: Building on the Foundation

You did it. You spent 30 days hunting for clues with your children. But the adventure does not end here. It is just beginning.

Here are a few tips to keep going:

1. Make it a habit, not a chore. Do not stress about reading the Bible for 30 minutes a day. A simple 5 minute rhythm before bed is better than an hour once a month.
2. Let them see you reading. Kids do what they see. Let them catch you reading your Bible. Let them see that it matters to you.
3. Ask "Where is Jesus?" in every story. Whenever you read a Bible story, ask your child, "Where do you see Jesus in this story?" This trains them to look for Jesus everywhere.
4. Recommended next steps. Read The Jesus Storybook Bible by Sally Lloyd-Jones. Read The Biggest Story by Kevin DeYoung. Keep pointing them to the Treasure.

You are doing a great job. Keep going.

Sneak Peek: The Bible's Biggest Secrets

If you loved this adventure, there is another one waiting for you. The Bible's Biggest Secrets takes you on a journey through 30 times the Old Testament predicted Jesus. It is full of activities, coloring pages, and simple prayers.

Final Call to Action

Scan the QR code below to get the next book in the series. Visit our website to download a free reading plan. Join our community of families. The adventure is not over. The journey is just beginning.

Cover Design Concept (The Children's Edition)

A bright yellow or sky blue background. A cartoon child detective with a magnifying glass. The child is looking at a big, glowing scroll with ancient writing on it. A small, friendly cartoon lamb is sitting next to the child. A golden crown is floating above the scroll. The title THE CLUES BEFORE THE KING is in a chunky, bouncy, playful font. The word KING is in bright red with a crown replacing the letter I. The overall feel is fun, exciting, and irresistible to a child.